

S&P Global Flash France PMI®

French private sector economy remains weak in August

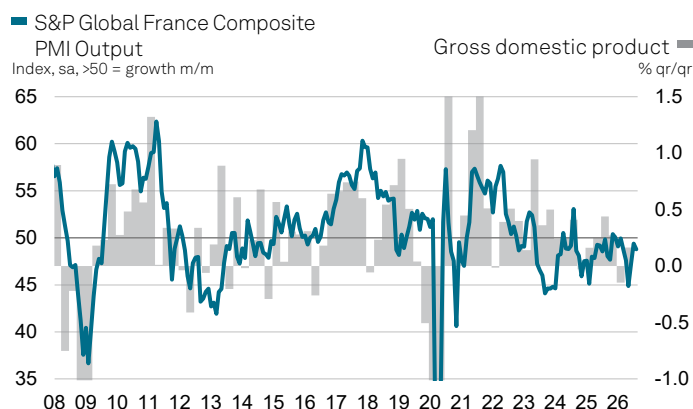
August 2026

Flash France PMI Composite Output Index: 48.8
(Jul: 49.4). 2-month low.

Flash France Services PMI Business Activity Index: 48.4 (Jul: 49.6). 2-month low.

Flash France Manufacturing Output Index: 50.7
(Jul: 48.5). 4-month high.

Flash France Manufacturing PMI: 51.5
(Jul: 49.8). 4-month high.



Data were collected 12-19 August 2026.

Sources: S&P Global PMI, INSEE via S&P Global Market Intelligence. © 2026 S&P Global

Business activity across France's private sector decreased slightly in August, according to the latest S&P Global 'flash' PMI report. Taken in tandem with July's slight contraction, August's modest (and marginally faster) decline puts the eurozone's second-largest economy on track for another sub-par quarter of survey data. Additionally, demand for French goods and services decreased at a quicker pace, while employment fell and business confidence weakened.

Meanwhile, input price inflation slowed to a five-month low, indicating receding cost pressures, although the rate of increase in output charges was broadly unchanged.

The headline S&P Global Flash France Composite Output Index – which is based on approximately 80-90% of total survey responses and intended to give an early indication of the final figures – slipped to 48.8 in August, from 49.4 in July, signalling a quicker rate of decline in private sector business activity when compared with the month prior.

According to data broken down by sector, August's contraction was entirely driven by services companies as manufacturing production increased for the first time since April. In some cases, extreme heat was cited as a reason for lower activity levels.

August survey data indicated a worsening of demand conditions faced by French private sector firms. New orders decreased modestly, extending the current period of falling sales volumes to nine months. New export business was a notable drag, with the contraction here picking up pace once again.

French private sector companies continued to make inroads into their backlogs of work midway through the third quarter. The extent to which outstanding orders were

Comment

Joe Hayes, Senior Principal Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"While the weather certainly heated up across Europe this summer, France's economy is barely lukewarm. The flash PMI report revealed another month of frail economic conditions, with some firms, mainly in the service sector, highlighting the extreme heat as a reason for lower activity and demand. There was some renewed vigour in the manufacturing sector, however, as production rose for the first time since April's stockpile-driven boost, potentially indicating some more stability for factories as inflation in the goods-producing sector remains on a downward trajectory. That said, inflation in the service sector ticked up for the first time since May as renewed pressures on global oil prices translated into higher fuel costs. Firms' decisiveness when passing on higher expenses could have implications for the inflation outlook."

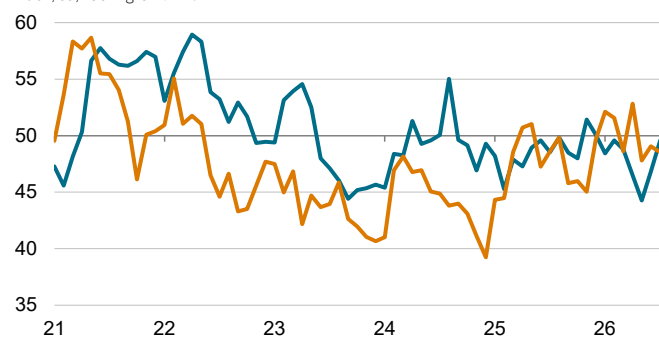
reduced was marked and the quickest in a year-and-a-half. Both manufacturers and service providers registered faster backlog clearances than in July.

Employment levels remained under pressure in August, as evidenced by a fourth consecutive monthly fall in payroll numbers. Industry-level trends diverged substantially, however, as the fastest rate of factory job creation in a year contrasted with service sector workforce cutbacks.

Meanwhile, cost pressures faced by private sector businesses in France continued to ease, in line with the trend since June. However, the rate of input price inflation remained above that seen immediately prior to the outbreak of war in the Middle East earlier in the year. The downward force came from the manufacturing sector as services companies reported a quicker rise in operating expenses. This was also true for output charges, with selling prices in the service sector rising at the fastest rate since May. A marked easing of goods price inflation meant the rise in charges at the composite level was little-changed from July.

Lastly, August 'flash' survey data indicated a fresh deterioration in business confidence. After hitting a four-month high in July, optimism towards the year-ahead outlook for business activity fell to its lowest level since May and was well below its survey trend. Uncertainty surrounding both the international landscape and domestic political situation weighed on sentiment, anecdotal evidence revealed.

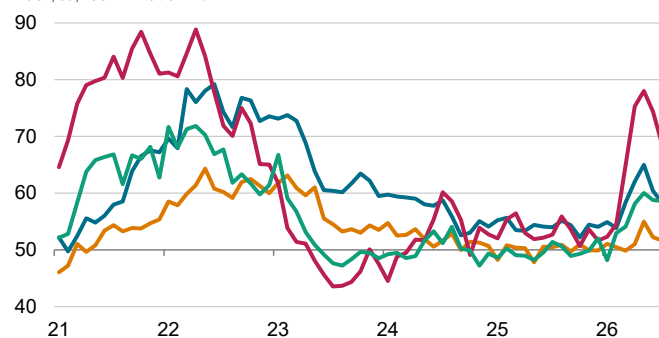
■ France Services PMI Business Activity
■ France Manufacturing PMI Output
Index, sa, >50 = growth m/m



S&P Global France Manufacturing PMI
Index, sa, >50 = improvement m/m



■ Services PMI Input Prices
■ Services PMI Prices Charged
■ Manufacturing PMI Input Prices
■ Manufacturing PMI Output Prices
Index, sa, >50 = inflation m/m



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Methodology

Final August data are published on 1 September for manufacturing and 3 September for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash France Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of around 400 manufacturers and 400 service providers. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable manufacturing and services indices using official manufacturing and services annual value added.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

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Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.4)

Services Business Activity Index = -0.1 (absolute difference 0.5)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.3)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

S&P Global

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PMI by S&P Global

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